

Proposal for Emoji: Liver

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Identification

Suggested name: Liver

Suggested keywords: hepatic; anatomy; organ; laboratory test; medicine safety; transplant; donation

Suggested category: People & Body - body-parts

Suggested sort location: Near Anatomical Heart, Lungs, and Brain in the body-parts subgroup.

Required Example Images

Size	Color	Black and white
18x18		
72x72		

The proposed image shows a full, asymmetrical liver with a larger rounded side, a smaller tapered side, a visible diagonal dividing line, and an optional small gallbladder beneath the lower edge. Vendors may change the angle, shading, and color, or omit the gallbladder, while preserving the broad unequal outline at emoji size.

I, Shuhan He, certify that these example images are original work created for this proposal, that I own all IP Rights in them, and that they contain no third-party artwork, logo, trademark, or text. I release the images under the CC0 1.0 Universal Public Domain Dedication and grant the rights required by the Unicode Emoji Proposal Agreement and License.

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Factors for Inclusion

A. Multiple meanings

Not applicable. The proposal relies on the direct literal meaning of the liver.

B. Use in sequences

Liver can combine with existing emoji to make two concise messages:

- Liver + Test Tube: “My liver-test results.”
- Liver + Pill + Warning: “This medicine may affect my liver.”

MedlinePlus uses the term “liver function tests” and explains that these tests can check for side effects of medicines that affect the liver.

Source: [MedlinePlus: Liver Function Tests](#)

C. Breaks new ground

Yes. Test Tube can say “test,” and Pill + Warning can say “medicine risk,” but neither can say which organ. Liver supplies the missing literal word in “my liver-test results” and “this medicine may affect my liver.”

Reference: [Current Unicode emoji list](#)

D. Distinctiveness

The image is broad and low, with a larger rounded side, a smaller tapered side, and a diagonal dividing line. At 18x18, those cues separate it from the tall Anatomical Heart, paired Lungs, round Brain, marbled Cut of Meat, and multiple Beans. The green gallbladder helps in color but is optional; the outline and unequal sides carry the identity in both color and black and white.

Liver	Anatomical Heart	Lungs	Brain	Cut of Meat	Beans
Color 72 					
Color 18 					
B/W 72 					
B/W 18 					

E. Expected usage level

Liver is a common standalone term with established uses in liver function testing, checking how medicine affects the liver, transplantation, and living donation. MedlinePlus documents the first two contexts, and NIDDK documents liver transplantation and living donors. The five required figures below measure search interest and published-word frequency, not demand for an emoji. They show worldwide Web interest comparable to `elephant`, lower but sustained worldwide Image Search interest, and substantially higher recent English-language published-word frequency.

Sources:

- [MedlinePlus: Liver Function Tests](#)
- [NIDDK: Liver Transplant](#)

Google Search

Captured 2026-07-26. With Tools open, Google reports about 183,000 results for the unquoted term `liver`.

Open the reproducible Google Search query

The screenshot shows a Google search interface for the term "liver". The search bar at the top contains the word "liver". To the right of the search bar are icons for clearing the search, voice search, image search, and a magnifying glass. Further right are icons for settings, sharing, and a grid of apps, followed by a "Sign in" button. Below the search bar, a horizontal menu includes "All", "Images", "Shopping", "Videos", "Forums", "Short videos", "More", and "Tools". The "Tools" menu is currently open, displaying a list of filters: "Any time", "All results", "Advanced Search", and "About 183,000 results (0.19s)".

On the left side of the results, there is an "AI Overview" section. It begins with a blue star icon and the text "AI Overview". Below this, a paragraph states: "The liver is the largest internal organ in the human body, located in the upper right side of the abdomen. It performs over 500 vital jobs, including filtering blood, making bile to digest food, and storing energy." Below the paragraph is a small icon of a liver and the text "Wikipedia +3".

Below the AI Overview is a section titled "Key Functions" with a "Show more" button and a downward arrow.

On the right side, there is a "Wikipedia" snippet. It features a small icon of a liver and the text "Liver - Wikipedia". Below this, it says "The liver is a major metabolic organ exclusively found in vertebrates, which..." and "Wikipedia".

Below the AI Overview and Key Functions, there is a search result from "Cleveland Clinic". The result includes the Cleveland Clinic logo, the URL "https://my.clevelandclinic.org/body/21481-liver", and the title "Liver: Where It's Located, Function & Anatomy". The snippet text reads: "Sep 26, 2025 — Your liver is located on the right side of your upper abdomen. Its functions include filtering blood, making chemicals and fighting ...".

Below the Cleveland Clinic result is a section titled "People also ask". It contains four questions, each with a downward arrow icon to its right:

- What are the first signs of a bad liver?
- What is the best drink to flush your liver?
- How do I fix liver problems?
- Where do you feel liver pain?

Below the "People also ask" section is a search result from "Wikipedia". It includes the Wikipedia logo, the URL "https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Liver", and the title "Liver". The snippet text reads: "The liver is a major metabolic organ exclusively found in vertebrates, which performs many essential biological functions such as detoxification of the organism".

At the bottom of the page, there is a section titled "Images".

Google Video Search

Captured 2026-07-26. With Tools open, Google Video Search reports about 72,400,000 results.

[Open the reproducible Google Video Search query](#)

Google

liver

Tools

- Any duration
- Any time
- Any quality
- All videos
- Any source
- Advanced Search

About 72,400,000 results (0.20s)

www.youtube.com › watch

How The Liver Works

For more information about how the liver works, visit: www.clevelandclinic.com/health/conditions/4wVclJE. The liver is a large organ in the upper right part of the abdomen.

YouTube · Cleveland Clinic · Aug 12, 2024

4 key moments in this video

www.youtube.com › watch

Chronic Liver Disease - Yale Medicine Explains

For more information on liver disease or #YaleMedicine, visit: <https://www.yalemedicine.org/conditions/liver-transplant> or ...

YouTube · Yale Medicine · May 2, 2026

3 key moments in this video

www.youtube.com › watch

Anatomy and Physiology of the Liver, Animation

the proper hepatic artery carrying oxygenated blood from the aorta, and the hepatic portal vein carrying venous drainage from most of the ...

YouTube · Allila Medical Media · May 1, 2023

5 key moments in this video

www.youtube.com › watch

Liver Patient Education Videos: Video 2 The Liver English

At Stanford Medicine Children's Health, our team of pediatric liver doctors (hepatologists) are leaders in treating complex pediatric liver ...

YouTube · Stanford Medicine Children's Health · May 30, 2024

www.youtube.com › watch

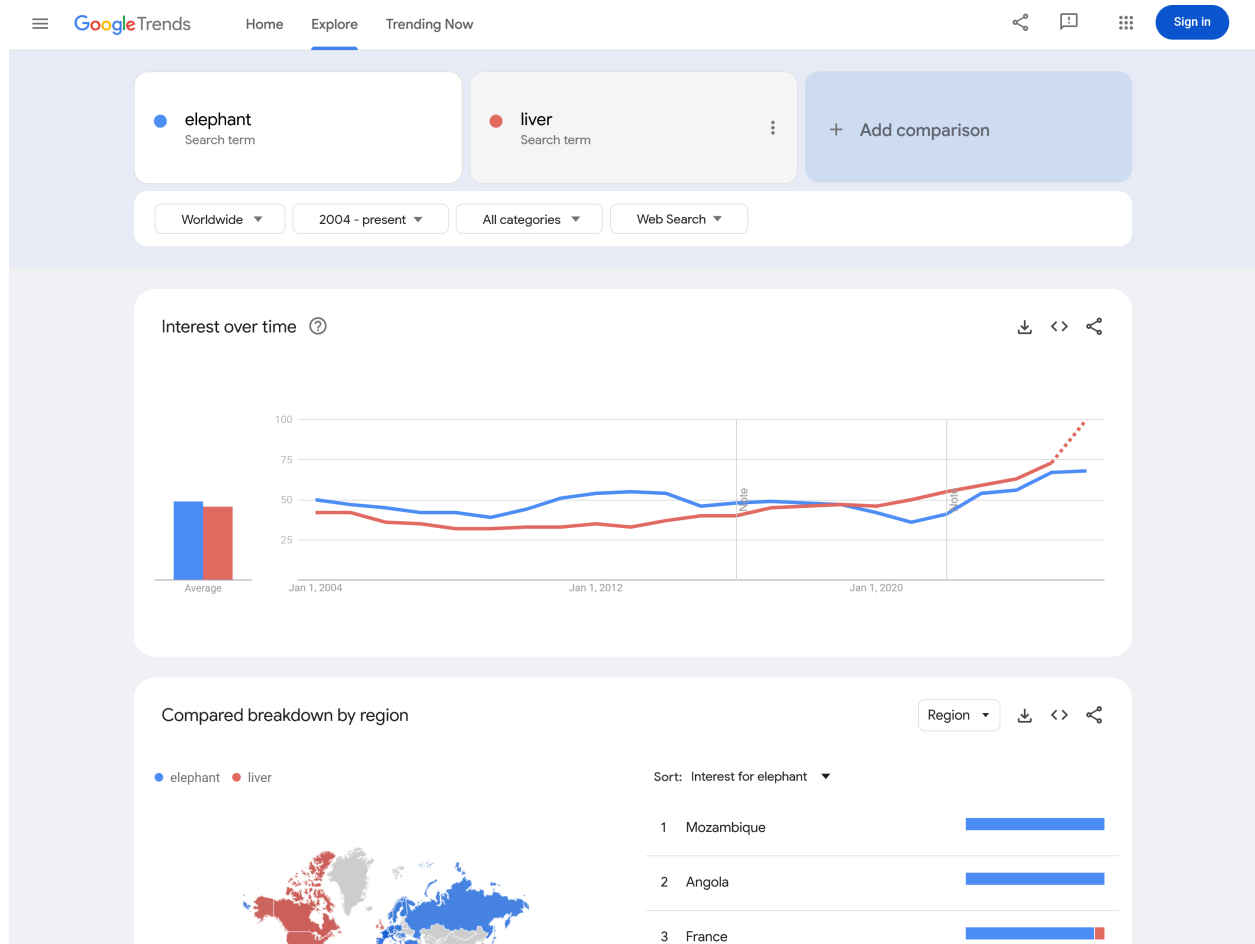
Understanding Cirrhosis & Liver Transplant: Risk Factors ...

Understanding Cirrhosis & Liver Transplant: Risk Factors, Symptoms, ...

Google Trends - Web Search

Captured 2026-07-26 using Worldwide, 2004-present, and Web Search. Liver and elephant have comparable average interest across the full period, and liver exceeds elephant in the most recent portion of the graph.

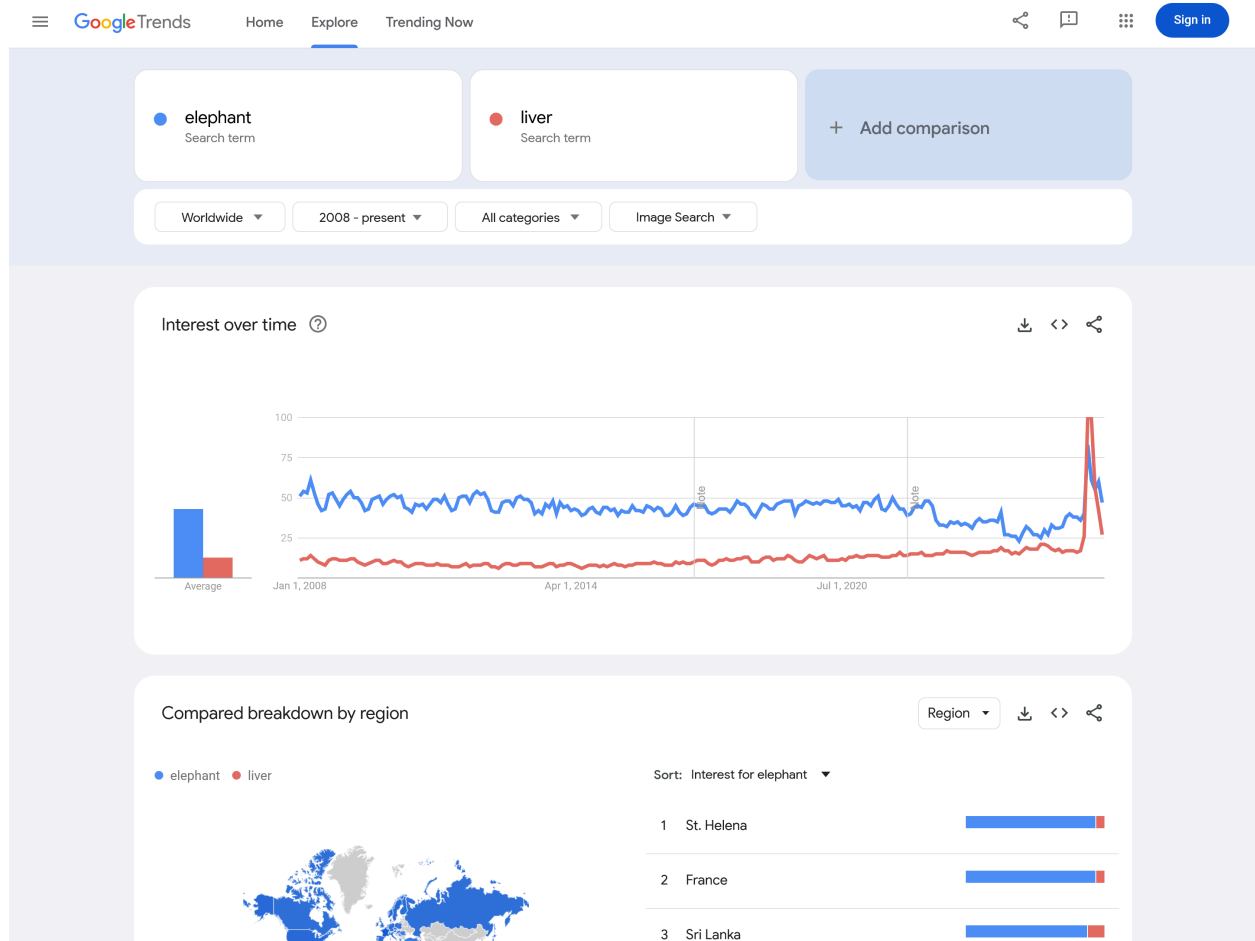
[Open the reproducible Worldwide Web Search comparison](#)



Google Trends - Image Search

Captured 2026-07-26 using Worldwide, 2008-present, and Image Search. Liver remains below elephant in average image-search interest while remaining present across the full period.

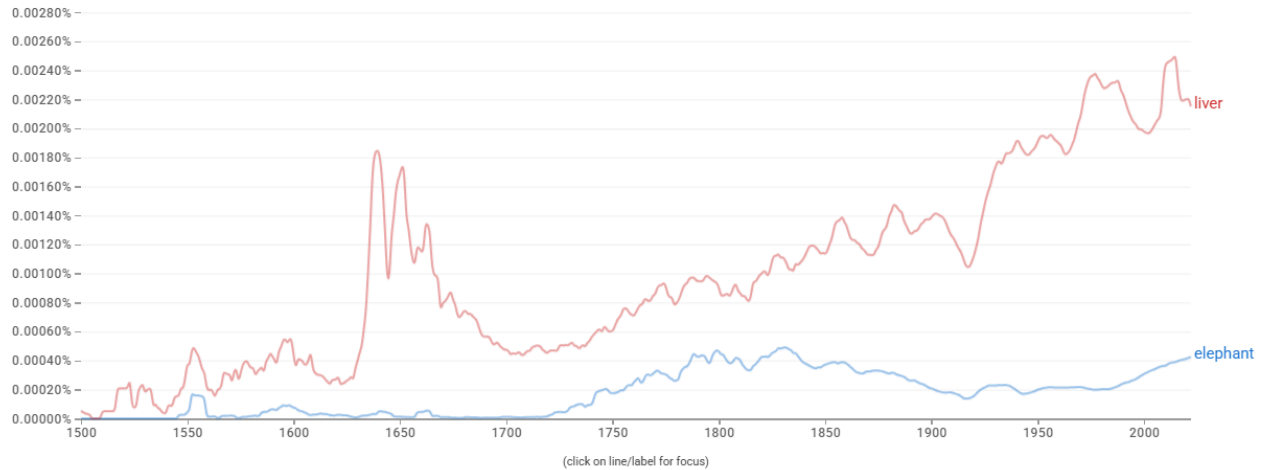
[Open the reproducible Worldwide Image Search comparison](#)



Google Books Ngram Viewer

Captured 2026-07-09 using the English corpus, 1500-2022, and smoothing 3. Liver substantially exceeds elephant in recent published-word frequency.

[Open the reproducible Google Books Ngram comparison](#)



F. Completeness

Not applicable. Anatomy is not a fixed set for this factor.

G. Compatibility

Not applicable. No qualifying popular-system pictograph is claimed.

Factors for Exclusion

A. Already represented

Test Tube can say “test,” and Pill + Warning can say “medicine risk.” Neither can say liver directly, so both lose the precise organ in the two cited messages.

B. Overly specific

The proposal is for the whole liver, not a lobe, disease, test result, transplant procedure, specialty, or campaign. It names the organ in anatomy, test results, medicine effects, transplantation, and donation.

C. Open-ended

Liver is the exact organ noun in the sourced phrases “liver function tests,” medicines that “affect the liver,” and “liver transplant.” Current emoji can express a test, medicine, warning, hospital, or people but cannot identify which organ those messages concern. This proposal encodes that reusable whole-organ referent, not any test result, disease, procedure, or anatomy category.

D. Transient

Liver is not tied to a campaign, event, or temporary technology. The English-language Ngram tracks the word through 1500-2022; MedlinePlus and NIDDK use it in guidance on tests, medicine effects, and transplantation.

E. Faulty comparison

Anatomical Heart, Lungs, and Brain are visual and sorting references only; their encoding is not evidence for this proposal. The case rests on Liver's sourced messages, measured word use and search interest, and design.

Other Information

Essential design cues are a broad asymmetrical outline, a larger rounded side, a smaller tapered side, and a diagonal dividing line visible at 18x18. The gallbladder, shading, angle, and exact color are optional. Vendors should avoid a rectangular food cut or a featureless filled oval.

[Official Unicode proposal guidance](#)